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The Money You Were Never Taught About

A 45-minute introduction to why the financial system feels broken —
and what to do about it

Three Things You'll Leave With Tonight

1

Why money exists — and why it matters more than you think

Most of us use money every day without knowing what it actually is or where it came from. That gap turns out to matter.

2

Why the system feels broken — and it's not your fault

Rising costs, wages that don't keep up, debt that's hard to escape. These aren't random. They have a cause.

3

That a better system exists — and anyone can access it

This isn't a dead end. Hard money and Bitcoin offer a real alternative — and understanding why is the first step.

PART 1 OF 3 — 10 MINUTES

The World You Live In

Everything you own exists because of this

This Morning Was Thousands of Years in the Making

“Every product you own, every service you use, every medicine that has ever saved a life — all of it exists because humans figured out how to trade with strangers they would never meet.”

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Your coffee came from Colombia

Grown, roasted, transported, and sold by people who have never met — coordinated entirely by prices and money.

Specialization built civilization

When people trade, they specialize. Economists call this lengthening the lines of production. The longer the chain, the more complex what we can build together.

But it only works with money

Without a trusted medium of exchange, global trade is impossible. Money didn't come from a government — it emerged naturally wherever people traded.

What Makes Money Good — In 60 Seconds

SCARCE

If anyone can create more of it, they will — and each unit buys less. Scarcity is what gives money its value.

DECENTRALIZED

Control the money and you control everything purchased with it. History shows what happens when that power is concentrated.

Gold checked nearly every box — the best natural money humanity ever found. It had one fatal flaw: too heavy to move without trusting someone. That trust was eventually abused.

Our current money fails both tests. It is neither scarce nor decentralized. That is not an accident — and it has consequences.

PART 2 OF 3 — 12 MINUTES

Why the System Feels Broken

And why it's not your fault

Things Aren't Getting More Expensive

Your money is getting weaker.

The instinctive explanation

Things cost more because they're getting harder to make and we're getting more functionality. That's just how the economy works — prices go up, everybody knows that. And quality suffers because it's all made in China.

The real explanation

We constantly get better at making things — production costs should be falling. Quality suffers not because of where products are made, but because manufacturers cut corners to keep prices low. The truth: prices aren't going up. The money we use is losing value. That's debasement — not inflation.

The key mechanism: when new money is created, it dilutes the value of every dollar already in existence. This is why our money loses its value — and where that value goes is the next question.

The Value Doesn't Disappear. It is redistributed.

1

New money is created

Banks, governments, and large financial institutions receive it first — before prices have risen anywhere.

2

Early recipients spend immediately

They buy assets — real estate, equities, businesses — at today's prices, knowing those prices will rise as the new money spreads.

3

By the time it reaches wages, prices have already moved

Workers and savers experience the new money not as higher pay — but as higher costs. The value was already taken.

Economists call this the Cantillon effect. It is not a conspiracy — it is a structural feature of how money creation works.

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The Numbers Tell the Story

97%

Loss in US dollar purchasing power
since the Federal Reserve was
created in 1913

1971

Year the last link between the dollar
and gold was severed — money
creation became unlimited

85×

Increase in US national debt since
1971 — from \$400 billion to over \$34
trillion

When the constraint on money creation was removed in 1971, something changed — not just in prices, but in who benefits from the system and who pays for it.

Four Things You've Already Felt

Housing out of reach

Housing isn't more expensive because it became more valuable. It's more expensive because money became less valuable — and the wealthy use real estate to protect their wealth from debasement.

Wages that never catch up

New money flows to financial institutions first. By the time it reaches wages, prices have already risen. Workers see rising costs, not rising pay. This has a name: the Cantillon effect.

Debt that feels inescapable

The modern monetary system cannot function without debt — money is literally created when banks issue loans. Saving is punished; borrowing is subsidized. Debt is the rational response, not a personal failure.

Quality that keeps declining

Not greed. Not cheap foreign manufacturing. When inflation erodes purchasing power, consumers buy on price, producers cut costs, quality falls. The monetary system sets the incentives.

PART 3 OF 3 — 8 MINUTES

There Is a Better Way

Hard money restores what debasement destroys

When Money Holds Its Value, Everything Changes

Today — soft money	Hard money world
Saving is punished — money loses value sitting still	Saving is rewarded — your money holds its value over time
Debt is rational — repay with cheaper future dollars	Debt is taken seriously — it costs what it costs
Build to be replaced — quality declines by design	Build to last — reputation compounds over generations
Governments spend without limit — cost is invisible	Governments face real constraints — spending has consequences

Bitcoin: Hard Money That Can Actually Travel

Gold's fatal flaw was fixed.

Gold checked every box for good money — except portability. Moving it required trusting custodians. That trust was always eventually abused. Every gold standard collapsed at that point.

In 2009, Bitcoin solved this. For the first time in history: money that is scarce, portable, and controlled by no one. Sent anywhere in the world instantly, verified by mathematics, with a fixed supply of 21 million that no government or bank can change.

Fixed supply: 21 million

Hard capped by mathematics. No central bank, no government, no institution can create more. The first money in history with a provably fixed supply.

No trusted third party needed

Send value directly between two people anywhere on earth. No bank. No exchange. No payment processor. Two people, transacting directly.

This already exists

Introduced in 2009. Operating continuously for fifteen years. A protocol — like the internet — running on thousands of computers simultaneously worldwide.

What You Now Understand

The monetary system is not a law of nature. It is a human invention — and human inventions can be changed. Understanding is where that change begins.

Trade created civilization. Money makes trade possible. Most people have never thought about where it came from — or what makes it work.

The current monetary system removes the constraint that kept money honest. The consequences — rising costs, stagnant wages, inescapable debt — are structural, not random.

Hard money and Bitcoin offer a real alternative. For the first time in history, we have money that is scarce, portable, and controlled by no one.

Questions — and Where to Go From Here

Questions to start with:

1. Which of the four consequences hit closest to home for you?
2. What's the strongest pushback you have on what you heard tonight?
3. If savings actually held value — what would you do differently?
4. What do you want to understand more deeply?

The full story

freemarketwatch.world/learn — six-act written series covering all of tonight in depth. Free.

Six-session deep dive

A structured group series — two hours per session, six sessions. Available for communities who want to go deeper together.

The essential read

The Bitcoin Standard by Saifedean Ammous — the definitive economic case. Start here if you read one thing.

See the data live

freemarketwatch.world — currencies, purchasing power, and monetary data in real time.